

PRD: Limited Admin Access

1. Overview

5Mins needs a **Limited Admin** role that sits between full Admin and Team Manager, giving regional coordinators, entity leads, and similar mid-level operators admin-like capabilities scoped to a dynamic subset of users. The immediate driver is the Millenium deal (hotel chain needing per-property admins), but the design must generalise to any multi-entity organisation - regions, brands, sites, divisions.

This PRD focuses on **the admin-facing experience of making a user a Limited Admin and defining their scope**. It covers the entry point (People page row menu), the dedicated Limited Admin side drawer, the scope-definition condition builder inside that drawer, and the save behaviour.

The MVP targets end of September 2026, scoped to a single custom field with multi-value OR conditions. Fast-follow and Phase 2 expand to multiple fields, Region scoping, and richer preview.

2. Jobs To Be Done

Main Job

When I am a full Admin of an organisation with multiple entities (hotels, regions, offices), **I want to** delegate day-to-day admin tasks to a trusted person within each entity **so I can** decentralise operations without exposing the entire organisation's data to every delegate.

Job Map

Stage	What the Admin does	Current pain / workaround
Define	Decide which person should manage a subset of the org	Mental decision - no friction here
Locate	Find that person in the system	People page exists; no issue
Prepare	Understand what the Limited Admin role entails	No Limited Admin role exists today; must choose between full Admin (too much access) or Team Manager (too narrow)
Configure	Assign the role and define the scope (which users this person manages)	Impossible today - no scoped role, no condition builder
Confirm	Review the assignment before saving - verify scope correctness and capability bundle	No confirmation flow exists

Execute	Save and have the system enforce the scope	No server-side scope filtering today
Monitor	Verify the Limited Admin sees only what they should	Would require logging in as that user; no preview or audit
Resolve	Change scope or revoke the role when the person moves	Would need to remove full Admin and reassign - risky manual process

Users struggle most at **Prepare → Configure → Confirm**. These are the stages this PRD directly addresses.

Related Jobs

- **Limited Admin's own job:** "When I log into 5Mins, I want to see only the people and data I'm responsible for, so I can focus without being overwhelmed or confused by irrelevant information."
- **Compliance officer's job:** "When auditing who can see what, I want to quickly see each admin's scope, so I can confirm we meet data-governance requirements."
- **IT administrator's job:** "When a custom field's values change (e.g., a hotel is renamed), I want scoped roles to remain valid, so I don't create silent access failures."

Emotional & Social Dimensions

- **Assigning Admin feels:** confident that they are giving the right level of access - not too much, not too little. They want to feel in control and responsible.
- **Limited Admin feels:** empowered and trusted. They should not feel like a "lesser" admin; the interface should feel purposeful, not crippled.
- **Organisation perceives:** professional, governed, enterprise-ready. The ability to delegate admin access signals maturity.

3. Goals

1. **An Admin can assign the Limited Admin role and define scope in a single, continuous flow** - from the People page, via a side drawer, without navigating away.
2. **Scope is expressed as conditions on custom user fields** (MVP: one field, multi-value OR) and resolves dynamically as user data changes.
3. **The Admin has clarity before saving** - they see what scope they defined, what capabilities the Limited Admin will have, and what surfaces will be hidden.
4. **The design generalises beyond Millenium** - it works for any custom field, any number of values, and is architecturally ready for multi-field AND conditions in fast-follow.

5. **The system prevents misuse** - only full Admins can create Limited Admins; role changes are never auto-saved; orphaned scope conditions surface a visible error state.
-

4. Job Stories

Assigning the role

- **When** I see a person on the People page who should manage a subset of our organisation, **I want to** assign them the Limited Admin role from the row's context menu, **so I can** initiate the delegation without leaving the list.
- **When** the role-assignment drawer opens, **I want to** see a clear description of what "Limited Admin" means (capabilities included and excluded), **so I can** be certain this is the right role before configuring scope.

Defining scope

- **When** I am setting up a Limited Admin's scope, **I want to** pick a custom field (e.g., "Hotel name") and select one or more of its values (e.g., "Hotel A", "Hotel B"), **so I can** define exactly which users this person will manage.
- **When** I select multiple values for the same field, **I want to** see that these are combined with OR logic (and have this clearly labelled), **so I can** trust the scope matches my intent.
- **When** I have defined the scope, **I want to** see a dynamic summary line (e.g., "Limited Admin for Hotel A, Hotel B"), **so I can** verify correctness at a glance without re-opening the condition builder.

Saving

- **When** I am about to save the Limited Admin assignment, **I want to** see the scope summary and what the role includes in the drawer itself, **so I can** save with confidence and without a separate confirmation step.
- **When** I save, **I want to** receive clear feedback that the role was applied successfully, **so I can** move on with confidence.

Modifying and revoking

- **When** a Limited Admin's responsibilities change, **I want to** edit their scope or remove the role from the same People page entry point, **so I can** keep access aligned with the organisation's structure.
- **When** a custom field used for scoping is deleted or a value is removed, **I want to** see a visible warning on the affected Limited Admin's scope, **so I can** fix the orphaned condition before it

causes silent access failures.

Dual roles

- **When** a person is already a Team Manager and I make them a Limited Admin, **I want to** be told that this replaces their Team Manager role, **so I can** avoid creating access conflicts. The two roles are mutually exclusive.
-

5. Requirements

Functional Requirements

FR-1: Entry Point - People Page Row Menu

- The three-dot context menu on each person row in the People page **must** include a "Make Limited Admin" action. For an existing Limited Admin the menu **must** offer "Edit scope" and "Remove Limited Admin" instead.
- This action **must** open a side drawer (consistent with the product's established pattern for role edits).
- The action **must** only be visible to full Admins. Limited Admins **must not** see this action.
- If the person is already a full Admin, the Limited Admin option **must** be disabled or hidden with a tooltip explaining that full Admins already have unrestricted access.

FR-2: Limited Admin Drawer - Structure

- The drawer is dedicated to the Limited Admin role. It **must not** contain a role selector; other roles (Learner, Team Manager, Admin) are managed elsewhere.
- The drawer **must** show the person (name and avatar), a short plain-language description of the Limited Admin role, the scope-definition section, and the Save and Cancel actions.
- The role description **must** cover:
 - **Capabilities included:** view/search/edit people in scope, single invite (fast-follow), enrol and bulk-enrol in scope, edit enrolments, view and export Learning Records in scope, browse 5Mins library, create/edit/publish own courses, set enrolment dates and sponsor.
 - **Capabilities excluded:** Reports, Teams, Cohorts, Your Content, Custom Fields admin, Skills, Events, Automations, Settings, role management, delete users, bulk invite.
 - **Navigation surfaces:** 5Mins Courses, Your Courses, Learning Records, Help.

FR-3: Scope Definition - Condition Builder (MVP)

- The scope-definition section is the drawer's main content and **must** be visible as soon as the drawer opens.
- **MVP scope:** one custom-field condition row - a field dropdown (listing all custom user fields configured by the tenant) and a multi-value picker for that field's values.
- Multiple values within the same field **must** be combined with OR logic, and this **must** be visually indicated (e.g., "is any of" operator label or OR chips between values).
- The scope section **must** include a dynamic summary line that updates as values are selected (e.g., "Scope: Hotel name is Hotel A or Hotel B").
- The field dropdown **must not** list system fields (name, email) - only custom user fields.
- If no custom fields exist for the tenant, the scope section **must** display an informational message directing the Admin to create custom fields first, and the Save button **must** be disabled.

FR-4: Scope Definition - Fast-Follow Extension

- In fast-follow, the scope builder **must** support multiple condition rows (multiple custom fields), combined with AND logic between fields.
- Each row: field dropdown + operator ("is any of") + multi-value picker + delete button.
- An "Add condition" button **must** allow adding additional field rows.
- A live "N people in scope" count **must** update dynamically as conditions change.
- Region **must** be available as a scope field in addition to custom fields.

FR-5: Save Behaviour

- There is no separate confirmation view. The drawer itself shows the person, the scope summary line and the short role description, so Save applies the change directly.
- On success the drawer closes and a toast names the scope, e.g. "Ana is now a Limited Admin for Hotel A and Hotel B". The People page row updates to show the Limited Admin badge.
- If the person currently holds Team Manager, the drawer **must** show an inline warning (see FR-8) and the primary action reads "Replace Team Manager Role".
- Removing the Limited Admin role **must** go through the standard destructive-action confirm dialog (see FR-6).
- Role changes **must not** auto-save; an explicit Save is always required.

FR-6: Editing and Revoking

- Re-opening the drawer for an existing Limited Admin **must** pre-populate the current scope conditions.
- An Admin **must** be able to change scope values or remove the Limited Admin role ("Remove Limited Admin" in the row menu or in the drawer).
- Removing the Limited Admin role **must** open the standard destructive-action confirm dialog, warning that scoped access will be revoked, and then clear the scope definition.

FR-7: Orphaned Scope Handling

- If a custom field used in a Limited Admin's scope is deleted, the system **must** display a visible error/warning state on that scope condition (e.g., "Field deleted - scope invalid") and restrict the Limited Admin's access to an empty scope until an Admin corrects it.
- If a specific value within a scoped field is removed, the system **must** remove that value from the scope condition and, if no values remain, treat the scope as invalid with the same error state.
- The People page **must** display a visual indicator (e.g., warning icon) next to any Limited Admin with an invalid/orphaned scope.

FR-8: Mutual Exclusivity with Team Manager

- **Decision (4 Sep 2026):** Limited Admin and Team Manager are mutually exclusive. A person holds one or the other, never both. Rationale: two scoped roles with different scope mechanisms (team-based vs. field-based) create ambiguous access boundaries and complicate both the UI and server-side enforcement. Team scoping for Limited Admins arrives in Phase 2.
- The drawer **must** warn the Admin if the person currently holds Team Manager and they are about to assign Limited Admin: "This will replace their Team Manager role. They will no longer manage their current team." The primary action then reads "Replace Team Manager Role".

FR-9: Access Control

- Only full Admins can assign, edit, or revoke the Limited Admin role.
- Limited Admins **must not** see role-management options for any user.
- There is no cap on the number of Limited Admins per tenant.
- Overlapping scopes between Limited Admins are permitted and require no special UI treatment.

FR-10: MVP vs. Multi-Field Conflict Resolution

- **Conflict flagged:** The Confluence MVP spec limits scope to a single custom field, but the clarifying answers indicate multi-field support is desired. **Recommendation:** Build the data model to store multiple conditions from day one (array of {field, operator, values} objects), but constrain the MVP UI to a single condition row with an architecture note. This avoids schema migration for fast-follow and keeps the MVP visually simple.

6. Research & Best Practices

Narrative Synthesis

The Limited Admin pattern - variously called "delegated administration," "scoped admin," or "group admin" - is a well-established enterprise SaaS pattern. The research dossier confirms both the necessity and the dominant design patterns.

Role architecture. The most usable role systems keep a small, clearly differentiated set of roles with plain-language descriptions shown at assignment time ([SaaS Permissions & Roles UX Patterns](#)). The

setting.page permissions UX guide explicitly warns against creating too many near-duplicate roles ("Admin, Limited Admin, Workspace Admin, Content Admin") without clear separation, and recommends role cards with disclosure drawers rather than exposing every permission by default ([User Permissions Settings UX](#)). This validates our approach of a single "Limited Admin" role with a fixed capability bundle (no per-action customisation) and a drawer-based assignment flow.

The "role + scope" two-step. Microsoft Entra ID's Administrative Units pattern - select role → add assignment → choose user → select scope - is the dominant enterprise approach ([Delegated Admin with Administrative Units](#)). LoginRadius formalises this as four components: Central Admin, Delegated Admin, Scope Definition, and Permission Limits ([Delegated Administration](#)). Our drawer flow mirrors this: choose the person → define scope → save.

Sana Labs as the closest competitor. Sana's Group Admin role is scoped by group membership (static or smart groups) and by manager-attribute assignment. Critically, Group Admins do not get automatic access - an administrator must explicitly assign scope, and without it, the "Manage" pages appear blank ([Quick Guide for Group Admins](#)). Sana uses three roles: Admin, Group Admin, and Learner, with role assignment accessed via Manage → Users → click user → Settings button ([User Roles](#)). Our approach improves on Sana by using dynamic, attribute-based scoping (custom fields with OR/AND conditions) rather than static group assignment, which reduces maintenance burden.

Scope definition as a condition/rule builder. The UI-Patterns.com rule builder pattern describes the canonical approach: each rule as a separate line with field selector, operator, and value picker, with AND/OR logic between conditions ([Rule Builder Design Pattern](#)). ServiceNow's Horizon design system provides a production-grade reference implementation with contextual operators, value pickers, and grouping controls ([Condition Builder Component](#)). For MVP (single field, multi-value OR), a simplified version of this pattern suffices; the full condition builder activates in fast-follow.

RBAC governance. IBM's RBAC implementation guide warns against role explosion, privilege creep, and scattered permission checks ([RBAC Implementation Guide](#)). Our decision to keep a fixed capability bundle (not per-action customisation) directly mitigates role explosion. The eLearning Industry guide advocates delegated administration scoped to departments or regions, and recommends immediate access revocation on role changes and regular permission audits ([Best Practices for Managing User Roles in an LMS](#)). Auth0's delegated admin approach uses organisation-specific scopes via tokens, demonstrating the "virtual tenant" model ([Delegated Administration Dashboard](#)).

LMS-specific patterns. LatitudeLearning defines a four-tier admin hierarchy where Location Administrators manage users only for their location ([Roles and Access to LMS Functionality](#)). Educate Me describes delegated LMS administration with scoped feature menus varying by role level ([Delegated Administration in LMS](#)). Both reinforce that our Limited Admin's reduced navigation (5Mins Courses, Your Courses, Learning Records, Help) is standard practice.

Experience design for roles. DRC Systems recommends that the best products show meaningfully different interfaces based on what a user actually does, not just what they can see, and advocates role previews so admins can simulate the user experience before applying changes ([Scoped Admin Role Assignment UX Best Practices](#)). While a full preview is out of scope for MVP, the drawer's role description and scope summary serve as a lightweight version of this.

UX References

App	Flow / Screen	URL	Pattern Description	Relevance
Airwallex	Admin role assignment with scope/permissions	View	Role assignment drawer with permission selection in settings	Direct reference for structuring the Limited Admin drawer with role + permission summary
Pipedrive	Role/permission settings	View	Role editing with field selection	Shows field-level role configuration in a CRM context - relevant to field-based scope definition
Deel	Admin role assignment	View	HR platform role assignment with scope selection	People-management platform with scoped admin roles - closely matches our domain
Revolut Business	Admin role/permissions settings	View	Business admin role configuration	Multi-entity financial product handling scoped admin roles - validates the multi-entity generalisation
Supabase	Role/permissions settings	View	Developer platform role assignment	Technical role assignment with scope controls - reference for clean, minimal role drawer
Gusto	User role edit with field selection	View	HR platform role/field editing in drawer/form	Drawer-based role editing with multi-value field pickers - directly applicable to our drawer pattern
Jira	Role/field editing in side panel	View	Project management field editing	Familiar Atlassian side-panel field editing with multi-value selection - team is likely already familiar
Vercel	Condition/rule builder with field and value selection	View	Condition builder with field dropdown and value picker	Directly relevant to the scope-definition condition builder - clean, minimal implementation
beehiiv	Condition builder for audience filtering	View	Segment/audience rule builder with multi-value fields	Dynamic user segment builder via field + value conditions - mirrors scope definition

Flodesk	Audience condition builder	View	Rule builder for audience segmentation	Email platform's segment builder - reference for visual treatment of OR conditions
Apollo	Contact filter/condition builder	View	Advanced filter builder with AND/OR and multi-value pickers	Sophisticated condition builder - reference for fast-follow multi-field AND/OR UI
Twingate	People list row menu with role options	View	Three-dot row menu on people list with role/edit actions	Directly relevant to the entry point: triggering role change from row context menu
Tailscale	People list with contextual actions	View	People list row actions	Security-focused product exposing user management actions from a list - validates row-menu pattern
Asana	Team member list with role actions	View	Member list with contextual role-change options	Role changes from a member list - validates discoverability of role actions in list context
15Five	People list admin actions	View	HR/people platform row menu with edit actions	HR platform's approach to people-list contextual actions - domain-appropriate reference

Built for Mars Lessons

Title	Type	URL	Lesson	Relevance
Hiding the advanced onboarding	UX bite	View	Progressive disclosure: hide advanced configuration behind a collapsible section so users engage with the core action first, then expand for complexity.	Partly applicable: the drawer is dedicated to Limited Admin, so scope is the primary content. Keep fast-follow extras (additional condition rows, live count) behind an "Add condition" action.
Upselling non-paying users	UX bite	View	When an action affects another person, show exactly who will be affected and what will happen. Transparency about consequences reduces hesitation.	Applies to the drawer's role description and the Team Manager warning: the assigning admin should see exactly what the Limited Admin will gain access to and what they will lose.

Slack's dynamic subtitles	UX bite	View	Contextualising a label with dynamic, situation-specific detail adds certainty without clutter.	Applies to the scope summary: dynamically show "Limited Admin for Hotel A, Hotel B" beneath the role label as values are selected.
How (and why) Wise leverage radical transparency	Case study	View	Radical transparency in showing exactly what a change does builds trust. Show clear before/after comparison so users understand precisely what they are getting.	Relevant to the drawer's scope summary line and the save toast: transparent display of the scope before and after saving builds admin confidence.

7. Plan of Action

Phase 0: Alignment & Data Model (Week 1)

- ☐ Resolve the MVP vs. multi-field conflict with engineering: confirm the data model stores an array of conditions `{{field_id, operator, values[]}}` from day one, but MVP UI renders only one row.
- ☒ Limited Admin and Team Manager are mutually exclusive (decided 4 Sep 2026); update the Confluence spec.
- ☐ Define the API contract for scope storage and the server-side enforcement points (course-enrolments table, Learning Records, enrol people-picker).
- ☐ Add "Limited Admin" as a role option in the backend role enum.

Phase 1: Entry Point & Drawer Shell (Week 2)

- ☐ Add a "Make Limited Admin" action to the three-dot row menu on the People page - visible only to full Admins. Existing Limited Admins get "Edit scope" and "Remove Limited Admin" instead.
- ☐ Implement the side drawer shell: header (person's name + avatar), short plain-language role description, scope-definition section, Save and Cancel. No role selector.
- ☐ If the person is already a full Admin, hide or disable the action with a tooltip.

Phase 2: Scope Definition - MVP Single-Field Condition (Week 2–3)

- ☐ Build the scope-definition section: one condition row with a field dropdown (populated from tenant's custom user fields) and a multi-value tag picker for the selected field's values.
- ☐ Label the operator as "is any of" to make OR logic explicit.

- ☐ Implement the dynamic summary line below the condition row: "Scope: [Field name] is [Value 1] or [Value 2] or ..." - updates on every selection change (per BFM "Slack's dynamic subtitles" pattern).
- ☐ Handle edge case: no custom fields configured → show info message + disable Save.
- ☐ Handle edge case: field selected but no values chosen → disable Save with inline validation message.

Phase 3: Save & Feedback (Week 3)

- ☐ No separate confirmation view. Save applies directly from the drawer; "Cancel" discards. No auto-save.
- ☐ If the person is a Team Manager, show the inline warning and relabel the primary action "Replace Team Manager Role".
- ☐ On save: API call to update user role + scope; success toast naming the scope; People page row updates to show the Limited Admin badge.
- ☐ If saving fails, show inline error in the drawer without closing it.

Phase 4: Edit, Revoke & Orphan Handling (Week 3–4)

- ☐ Re-opening the drawer for an existing Limited Admin pre-populates current role and scope conditions.
- ☐ Removing the Limited Admin role opens the standard confirm dialog: "This will remove their Limited Admin scope. They will no longer manage [scope summary]."
- ☐ Implement orphaned-scope detection: on drawer open, check if the scoped field still exists and values are still valid. If not, show a warning banner in the drawer: "Scope invalid - the field [name] has been deleted / the value [name] has been removed. Please update the scope."
- ☐ Add a warning icon on the People page row for any Limited Admin with an invalid scope.

Phase 5: Fast-Follow - Multi-Field & Live Count (Weeks 5–7)

- ☐ Expand the scope section to support multiple condition rows (one per field), connected with AND logic between rows.
- ☐ Add "Add condition" button and per-row delete button.
- ☐ Add Region as an available scope field alongside custom fields.
- ☐ Implement live "N people in scope" count, debounced, updating as conditions change.
- ☐ Build the full scope-definition drawer variant with the condition builder UI (reference: Vercel, Apollo, beehiiv patterns from Mobbin).

Phase 6: Phase 2 - Team Scoping & Preview (Weeks 8–10)

- ☐ Add Team as a scope field option.
- ☐ Add remaining system fields: Function, Job Role, Country, Division, City.
- ☐ Implement cross-field AND logic in the server-side scope resolver.
- ☐ Add "Preview matched people" - a scrollable list showing the first N users matching the scope conditions, with a total count.

8. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
MVP vs. multi-field scope conflict - Confluence spec says single field; clarifying answers suggest multi-field. Engineering may build a single-field data model that requires migration later.	High - schema migration delays fast-follow	Store scope as an array of conditions from day one (<code>[{field, op, values}]</code>). MVP UI constrains to one row; data model is already extensible.
Replacing a Team Manager silently - Limited Admin and Team Manager are mutually exclusive, so making a Team Manager a Limited Admin removes their team access.	Medium - unexpected loss of team management	Show a clear warning when replacing Team Manager with Limited Admin and require explicit confirmation. Revisit in Phase 2 when team scoping is added to Limited Admin.
Orphaned scope from deleted custom fields - A full Admin deletes a custom field that another admin's scope depends on.	High - silent access failure; Limited Admin sees no users or, worse, all users	Detect orphaned fields/values on scope evaluation. Restrict Limited Admin to empty scope (deny-by-default) when scope is invalid. Show warning icon on People page.
Custom field proliferation - Tenants with many custom fields make the field dropdown unwieldy.	Low - UX friction	Use a searchable dropdown for the field selector. Consider grouping or recently-used ordering in fast-follow.
Performance of live scope count - For large tenants, counting matching users on every condition change may be slow.	Medium - laggy UX during scope definition	Debounce the count query (300–500ms). Show a loading spinner. Cache intermediate results. This is fast-follow, not MVP.
Privilege creep - Limited Admins accumulate scope over time without review.	Medium - governance risk	Log all scope changes. Recommend periodic access reviews in product documentation. Consider an admin audit log surface in a future phase (per RBAC Implementation Guide and eLearning Industry best practices).

Millenium timeline pressure - MVP must ship by end of September 2026; scope creep from multi-field desire could delay.	High - deal blocker	Strict MVP boundary: one field, multi-value OR, no live count, no preview. Multi-field is explicitly fast-follow. Weekly scope reviews with PM.
Drawer complexity - Condition builder, inline warnings and orphan states in a single drawer may overwhelm.	Medium - design debt, user confusion	User-test the drawer flow with 3–5 internal admins before launch. Keep MVP visually minimal (one condition row, direct Save, no confirmation view). Expand complexity only in fast-follow.